progress. *Second*, it is the idea of the nature resources which are available. Resources (i.e. natural as well as human) could be of indigenous origin or exogenous. Most of the countries doing planning tried to utilise their indigenous resources, yet some others tried to tap the exogenous resources too, taking leverage to their diplomatic acumen. For example, the first country going for national planning i.e. Soviet Union leveraged resources available in the East European countries. India also used exogenous resources for her development planning wherever it was necessary and possible to tap.[7]

By 1950s, planning had emerged as a method or tool of utilising resources to achieve any kind of goals for the policy-makers, around the world:

(i) Trying to achieve a particular size of family for different countries came to be known as ***family planning.***

(ii) The process of providing suitable physical and social infrastructure for the erstwhile or the upcoming urban areas came to be known as ***town/urban planning.***

(iii) A country trying to optimise the use of its revenues for different categories of expenditures came to be known as ***financial planning.*** Financial planning is more popularly known as ***budgeting.*** Every budget, be it of the government or of the private sector is nothing but excercises in the area of financial planning.

(iv) Similarly, at macro and micro levels, there might be any number of planning processes—agricultural planning, industrial planning, irrigation planning, road planning, house planning, etc.

Simply said, the art of achieving any kind of goal by the use of the resources we have is the process of planning. We may cite a very general example—students of a class are able to join the class at the right time coming from different places of their stay. How they are able to do so? All of them must be planning their time in such a way that they are able to join the class at the same time though their places of residence are not at an equal distance from the class. All might be having their own way of time planning—some might be having bed-tea, some might not, some might be